

Samsung SGH-S300

Live life in 16-bit colour

This new Triband handset with 16-bit colour from Samsung weighs only 76 grams and easily fits into your pocket. However, many people will criticise the long antenna, which interferes in handling the phone. The keys are big and very readable—even in the bright open areas. However, one glaring error is the placement of the [C] key below the scroll key. Due to this, your thumb unconsciously presses it while scrolling or entering the menus.

The external display is greyscale and displays the date, time, arrival of a new message, battery level and also flashes the incoming number. Unlike Nokia phones, the backlight timing can be adjusted to Long, Short, Medium, etc. and most importantly, the display is bright and vibrant. One shortcoming that we found is that the backlighting for the external display is automatically switched on when you open the phone, causing excessive energy consumption.

Surprisingly, the menu is very similar to Nokia phones. You can navigate the menu system in two ways—Page-

wise and Folder-wise. Another nice feature is the presence of pop up information when selecting any of the internal features of a menu. This prevents you from unnecessarily entering the submenus.

The phone supports Long Messages, and also allows you to format your text. However, you cannot

create folders and organise your messages, neither can you assign a ring tone as an Alert Tone. Another thing we found amiss was you that can't forward messages to more than one person at a time.

This phone is packaged with a neat set of features. However, its many flaws will be a point of concern, especially if you take into consideration the staggering price you have to pay.

SPECIFICATIONS

Tri-band, 80 x 40 x 20 mm, 128 x 128 pixels internal display, four-way navigation keys, dynamic font size, EMS, MMS receive only, polyphonic sounds, Java embedded, WAP 1.2.1, T9, currency converter, calendar, To Do list, speed dial, menu shortcuts, world clock

Samsung SGH-S300		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 24,399
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Hotcard Bizcard Finder

Your very own portable digital cardholder

Hotcard's Bizcard Finder is a portable device that can convert the A8 sized cards you have, to a digital format. This USB 1.1 card reader is an easy-to-carry, portable device that connects

to your laptop. Once scanned, all contact details of the card are automatically stored in predefined categories. The bundled software included in the package converts the scanned image to a

database of contact details.

First, you need to insert the empty card, provided in the box, to calibrate the scanner. The scanned image of the card is then shown with a grid layout for each contact detail. We scanned over 30 cards and the scanning accuracy was a little low with embossed cards.

The default file type of the saved contacts is DAT. The manufacturers have also provided the ability to export the list of contacts to Outlook's address book, the CSV (Comma Separated Values) format and Dbase III. The recommended option is to export it to the DBF format, which can be opened in MS Access.

Price: Rs 7,000
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Synchronisation of the database to cell phones and PDAs is a useful feature, but only limited to the brand names mentioned in the software—the Motorola 388, Minren PDA, Shang-WuTong PDA, Palm Address, WinCE contacts and Bizcard Finder.

Even though the device is a fine piece of hardware, the interface between it and the software is not up to standards. Within these limitations though, this product performs to expectations, and is a viable alternative to traditional card holders.

SPECIFICATIONS

USB 1.1 interface, scans a maximum of A8-sized cards

Hotcard Bizcard Finder		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Sony CLIE PEG-TG50

Work on the move while having fun

The CLIE runs on the Palm OS 5 operating system, which takes up 5 MB of the available 16 MB memory. Some of the things the CLIE can do is to act as a voice recorder, MP3 player and even a gaming device when used with a game controller. A speaker at the back of the CLIE outputs good quality sound. However, it'd be better to use a headphone, which Sony has unfortunately not included with the product. When used as a voice recorder, the CLIE performed well and recorded with good clarity. The CLIE also has a REC button on the side for

easy operation. The other buttons on the side include the Jog Dial for scrolling, a Back button whose function is similar to the Escape button function and of course the Power and Hold button.

Data entry into this device can be done in three ways. The common ways are through the digital keyboard and the Graffiti (text entry through handwriting recognition) area. The integrated keyboard below the LCD is the third mode of data entry. Come to think of it, most of the time, when anyone uses the CLIE, it will be held in one hand and the stylus will be in the other, so

